



TYPES OF FERNS



Adiantum Forms include *A. aleuticum* (above), with fingerlike deciduous fronds; *A. pedatum* with black-stalked segmented fronds; and evergreen *A. venustum*.



Asplenium The hart's tongue fern, *A. scolopendrium* (above), bears rosettes of long, glossy evergreen fronds. The foliage of *A. trichomanes* is divided into oblong segments.



Athyrium The lady fern, *A. filix-femina* (above), has deciduous fronds made up of long segments. The deciduous Japanese painted fern, *A. niponicum*, is very attractive.



Blechnum Deer fern, *B. spicant* (above), has narrow, dark green, divided evergreen fronds. *B. pennamaryna* is shorter and bears reddish young fronds that mature to green.



Dryopteris Most species of buckler fern produce large deciduous fronds, crested in some forms, arranged like an elegant shuttlecock.



Matteuccia The large-sized ostrich or shuttlecock fern, *M. struthiopteris* (above), bears large, pale green deciduous fronds divided into fingerlike segments.



Osmunda The royal fern, *O. regalis*, has very tall deciduous fronds divided into long segments, with rust-colored spore-bearing segments at the tips of some segments.



Polypodium This genus includes many hardy evergreen ferns; including the low-growing *P. vulgare* (above), with triangular-shaped dark-green fronds.



Polystichum Most holly or shield ferns are hardy with large, dark green, triangular evergreen fronds, divided into feathery segments, with shuttlecock-like crowns.



Ferns often naturalize in cracks in shady walls, softening the edges and adding interest.